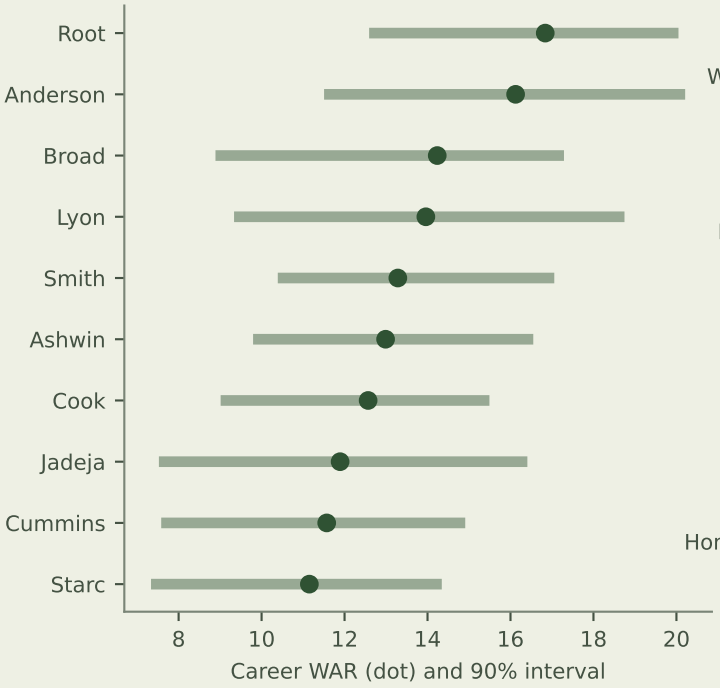
Test cricket Wins Above Replacement

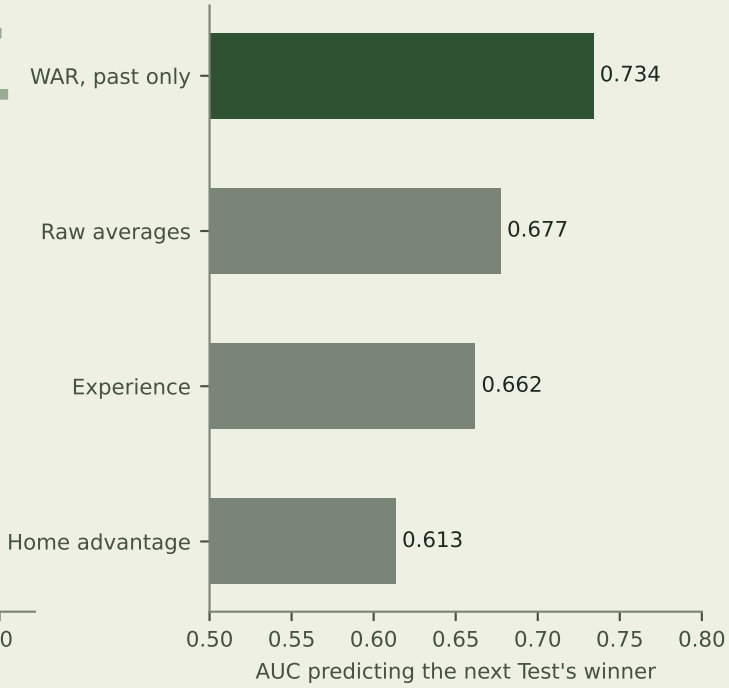
A ball-by-ball model of every Test since 2001, rebuilt nineteen times and tested on matches it never saw

- This is a Wins Above Replacement model for Test cricket, built ball by ball and rebuilt nineteen times. Every change was kept or dropped on held-out evidence.
- It rates Root first on 16.84 WAR, with Anderson, Broad, Lyon and Smith behind him. Across 100 refits of the whole model on resampled Tests, Root is first in 39% and in the top three in 72%. The order behind him is open.
- It predicts unseen Tests with an AUC of 0.9844. Ratings built only from a player's earlier matches predict the next results with an AUC of 0.734, against 0.677 for raw averages.
- Five real bugs turned up along the way, and one of them flipped who leads the table. Fifteen further ideas were tested and rejected.
- It leaves out fielding and careers before 2001, and the Australian spin factor is the least settled number in it.

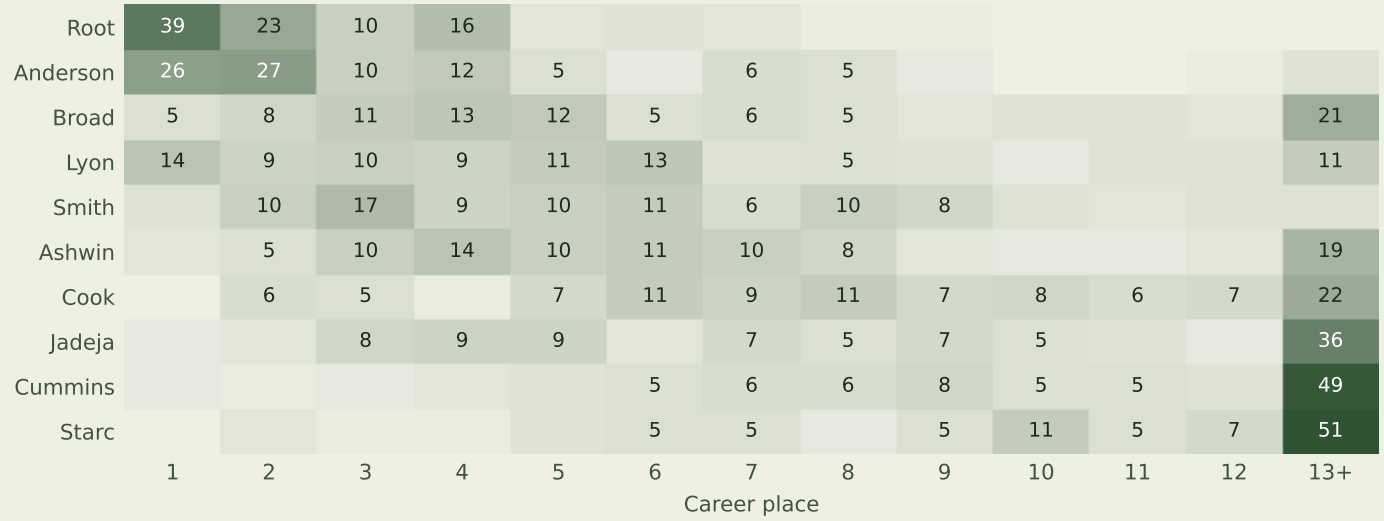
Top ten, 100 full refits of the model



Ratings built from earlier matches only



Share of draws, in per cent, in which each player finishes at each place



Measure Twice and Root Cause, Sidhant Sawlani. Every figure on this page is generated from the model's logs.